William Jones

Department of Economics · University of Houston · Houston, TX
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Education

University of Houston Expected May 2027
M.A. in Applied Economics *Houston, TX*

- D.W. Mitchell Merit Scholarship
- Fall 2026: Microeconomic Theory (ECON 6485), Macroeconomic Analysis (ECON 6475), Econometrics

University of Houston May 2026
B.S. in Economics, Minor in Mathematics *Houston, TX*

- GPA: 3.77/4.00. Dean's List: Spring 2025, Fall 2025, Spring 2026
- Summer Undergraduate Research Fellowship (SURF)
- Coursework: Econometrics, Time Series Analysis and Forecasting, Data Science and Statistical Learning, Statistics and Data Science, Labor Economics, Energy Economics, Monetary Policy, Economics of Money and Banking, Fixed Income Mathematics, Linear Algebra, Calculus I–III

Research Experience

Department of Economics, University of Houston July 2026 – Present
Research Assistant to Prof. Shahadath Hossain *Houston, TX*

- Support a two-stage field study of public-sector job queuing among university students in Bangladesh: a survey of about 2,560 students across 16 institutions with an embedded conjoint experiment, followed by an RCT.
- Built the full respondent-facing survey and conjoint experiment in Qualtrics, including all randomization logic. Proposed a third income level to estimate willingness to pay and nonlinear income effects, and attribute-order and randomization to reduce ordering bias.
- Wrote three sections of the pre-analysis plan (experimental design, data and definitions, analysis), including an original measure (η) of how students value the public-sector job bundle at equal pay.
- Caught a mismatch between the sampling plan and the pre-analysis plan that would have blocked pre-registration. Produced research memoranda and a literature review on conjoint design standards in LaTeX.

Office of Undergraduate Research, University of Houston May 2025 – Present
SURF Fellow, mentored by Dr. Dhanushka Peru *Houston, TX*

- Solo-authored a mixed-methods panel study of 23 Texas counties (2009–2023) using two-way fixed effects and instrumental variables models of social outcomes in oil-producing regions.
- Assembled an original county-year dataset from Census, ACS, CDC, NCHS, FBI, and Texas Education Agency sources.
- Designed and conducted IRB-approved interviews in Odessa, Texas to identify mechanisms behind the quantitative findings.

Research

A Look Into the Social and Economic Pressures of the Permian Basin
Working Paper, 2025, revised October 2026. Writing sample.

- Two-way fixed effects and IV (WTI × Permian exposure) panel analysis with original IRB-approved fieldwork. Within counties, income has no significant effect on teen birth rates, while single-parent household share is the strongest correlate. Robust to dropping single-parent share, county-specific trends, and a leads test. Replication code on website.

Do Macroeconomic Conditions Drive Crime? Evidence from Monthly U.S. Time Series Data, 2010–2025
Working Paper, 2026

- ARIMAX, SARIMAX, and VAR(12) analysis of national crime rates. A joint Granger causality test fails to reject that unemployment and income do not predict crime ($F = 1.30$, $p = 0.155$).

Fossil Fuel Prices and Clean Energy Equity Returns
Work in Progress

- Johansen cointegration and VECM forecasting of the iShares Global Clean Energy ETF (ICLN) against WTI crude oil and Henry Hub natural gas, with formal forecast optimality testing.

Classifying Income Distributions Using Machine Learning: Evidence from Census Microdata
Work in Progress

- K-nearest neighbors and support vector machine classifiers predicting household income categories from demographic and labor market characteristics.

Presentations

Research Poster, *A Look Into the Social and Economic Pressures of the Permian Basin*, April 2026
Undergraduate Research Day 2026, University of Houston

Technical Skills

Software: R, Stata, Python, SQL, MATLAB (coursework), LaTeX, Qualtrics, Excel, Power BI, Tableau
Methods: Panel and fixed effects models, instrumental variables, conjoint experiments, time series (ARIMA, VAR, VECM), cointegration testing, forecasting, clustered and robust inference, machine learning (KNN, SVM)

Other Experience

AIA Global Summer 2025
Commodity Analytics Training Program *Houston, TX*

- Ten-week program covering crude oil, NGL, and refined product markets and commercial analytics.

tasc Performance 2024 – Present
Sales Associate *Houston, TX*

- Run the store in the manager's absence and train new hires.

Activities

Economics Society, University of Houston

References

Available upon request.